Learn, practise, remember

A Notebook Forge demonstration

Read one section. Explain it without looking. Try the example, then return to check what you missed.

Every topic and subtopic has dedicated pages.

The following pages are authored from the selected sources or topic. Source material is content, not instructions to an agent.

Contents

A useful learning cycle 3

Active recall 4

Write a recall question 5

Use feedback 6

Plan the next session 7

A useful learning cycle

1 The idea

Choose one thing you want to understand. Read a short explanation, close the source, and explain the idea in your own words. Use feedback to decide what to practise next.

2 A small, repeatable routine

- Pick a narrow goal: explain a concept or complete a task.
- Try to recall or apply it before looking at the answer.
- Check your explanation and correct one specific gap.
- Return to the difficult part in a later session.

3 The cycle

```
CHOOSE A GOAL
  -> READ OR WATCH
  -> EXPLAIN FROM MEMORY
  -> CHECK AND CORRECT
  -> PLAN THE NEXT PRACTICE
```

4 An illustrative example

Goal: explain how a filter changes a list. Read one example, sketch the input and output from memory, then test a new input. The result gives you a concrete explanation to check.

5 Common mistake

A familiar-looking page can feel like understanding. Add a small task that reveals whether you can use the idea without looking.

6 Your turn

Name a topic you are learning. Write one sentence describing what you should be able to explain or do at the end of a short session.

Active recall

1 The idea

Make an attempt to retrieve the idea before checking the source. The attempt gives you something specific to compare with a reliable explanation.

2 Useful prompts

- Explain the concept to a beginner in three sentences.
- Draw the process and label each step.
- Predict the result of a small change.
- Give an example and a counterexample.

3 Worked example

After reading about SQL joins, close the notes. Sketch two tiny tables and predict an inner join result. Then check the output and explain any difference.

4 Common mistake

Turning the task into copying. Put the source aside for the first attempt, then use it deliberately for feedback.

5 Try it now

Close this page and explain the learning cycle. Reopen it, identify one missing step, and improve your explanation. You do not need to reproduce the wording exactly.

Write a recall question

1 The idea

A useful question tests a clear piece of understanding. Make it small enough to answer, and keep a way to check whether the answer is complete.

2 Build the question

- Choose a concept or action, rather than an entire chapter.
- Ask for explanation, prediction or a concrete example.
- Keep the expected answer separate from the question.
- Revise questions that are ambiguous or test only wording.

3 Question card

```
FRONT
What changes when a list is filtered?

BACK
The displayed items follow a condition.
Explain the input, condition and resulting items.
Give a tiny example and check it.
```

4 A nested subtopic gets its own page

This page sits under Active recall in the topic inventory. Dedicated-page mode includes every hierarchy level, even when a subtopic has children of its own.

5 Make one card

Write a question for your current topic. Answer it without notes, then compare with the source. If you cannot decide whether the answer is right, improve the question or its checking guide.

Use feedback

1 The idea

Compare your attempt with a trustworthy source or a clear expected result. Look for a specific difference that you can correct and practise.

2 What to inspect

- Was the main idea correct?
- Did the explanation omit a condition or exception?
- Does your example actually demonstrate the rule?
- Can you explain the correction without copying the source?

3 Worked example

Your sketch says all source items appear in the filtered list. A small test shows only matching items. Correct the explanation, then try another condition to see whether you understand the change.

4 Common mistake

Reading the correct answer and moving on immediately. Try the corrected explanation once more, using a different example if possible.

5 Correction log

My original answer: ____
The specific gap: ____
My corrected explanation: ____
A new example to check it: ____

Plan the next session

1 The idea

Use what you noticed in practice to choose the next small task. A useful plan says what to practise and how you will check it, rather than only naming a chapter to reread.

2 Choose your next step

- Keep one difficult question for another attempt.
- Revisit the topic in a later session.
- Change the example to check transfer.
- Adjust the plan to your deadline and current understanding.

3 A practical session note

```
TOPIC: _____________________________
NEXT TASK: _________________________
WHEN: ______________________________
HOW I WILL CHECK IT: _______________
WHAT STILL FEELS UNCLEAR: __________
```

4 Keep the plan realistic

There is no universal schedule in this demonstration. Choose a manageable return time, then adjust according to your recall and the time available.

5 Before you finish

Write one task for the next session. Include the material you will need and one clear sign that the task is complete.